

018. Chapter 2 Verses 48-51

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 2.48

योगस्थः कुरु कर्माणि सङ्गं त्यक्त्वा धनञ्जय ।
सिद्धयसिद्धयोः समो भूत्वा समत्वं योग उच्यते ॥ 48 ॥

yogasthaḥ kuru karmāṇi
saṅgaṃ tyaktvā dhanañjaya |
siddhyasiddhyoḥ samo bhūtvā
samatvaṃ yoga ucyate ||

- ◆ **yogasthaḥ** – established in Yoga; **kuru** – perform; **karmāṇi** – actions;
- ◆ **saṅgam** – attachment; **tyaktvā** – abandoning; **dhanañjaya** – O Dhananjaya (Arjuna);
- ◆ **siddhi-asiddhyoḥ** – in success and failure; **samaḥ** – even-minded; **bhūtvā** – becoming;
- ◆ **samatvam** – equanimity; **yogaḥ** – Yoga; **ucyate** – is called.

O Arjuna! Steadfast in Yoga, giving up all attachment, unmindful of success or failure, do your work. Such equanimity of mind is called Yoga.

VERSE 2.49

दूरेण ह्यवरं कर्म बुद्धियोगाद्धनञ्जय ।
बुद्धौ शरणमन्विच्छ कृपणाः फलहेतवः ॥ 49 ॥

dūreṇa hyavaram karma
buddhiyogāddhanañjaya |
buddhau śaraṇamanviccha
kṛpaṇāḥ phalahetavaḥ ||

- ◆ **dūreṇa** – by far; **hi** – indeed; **avaram** – inferior; **karma** – action;
- ◆ **buddhi-yogāt** – than the Yoga of wisdom; **dhanañjaya** – O Dhananjaya;
- ◆ **buddhau** – in wisdom; **śaraṇam** – refuge; **anviccha** – seek;
- ◆ **kṛpaṇāḥ** – wretched/pitiful; **phala-hetavaḥ** – those motivated by fruits.

O Arjuna! Work with attachment is far inferior to nishkama karma. Therefore seek refuge in desireless action with equanimity of mind. Those who work for fruits and rewards are wrecked.

VERSE 2.50

बुद्धियुक्तो जहातीह उभे सुकृतदुष्कृते ।
तस्माद्योगाय युज्यस्व योगः कर्मसु कौशलम् ॥ 50 ॥

buddhiyukto jahātiha
ubhe sukr̥taduṣkr̥te |
tasmādyogāya yujyasva
yogaḥ karmasu kauśalam ||

- ◆ **buddhi-yuktaḥ** – endowed with wisdom; **jahāti** – casts off; **iha** – in this life;
- ◆ **ubhe** – both; **sukr̥ta-duṣkr̥te** – good and evil deeds;
- ◆ **tasmāt** – therefore; **yogāya** – to Yoga; **yujyasva** – devote yourself;
- ◆ **yogaḥ** – Yoga; **karmasu** – in actions; **kauśalam** – skill.

The man of equanimity born of wisdom releases himself both from good and bad even in this life. Therefore strive for nishkama karma with an equal mind. Yoga is skill in action.

VERSE 2.51

कर्मजं बुद्धियुक्ता हि फलं त्यक्त्वा मनीषिणः ।
जन्मबन्धविनिर्मुक्ताः पदं गच्छन्त्यनामयम् ॥ 51 ॥

karmajaṃ buddhiyuktā hi
phalaṃ tyaktvā manīṣiṇaḥ |
janmabandhavinirmuktāḥ
padaṃ gacchantyanāmayam ||

- ◆ **karma-jam** – born of action; **buddhi-yuktāḥ** – endowed with wisdom; **hi** – indeed;
- ◆ **phalam** – fruit; **tyaktvā** – abandoning; **manīṣiṇaḥ** – the wise;
- ◆ **janma-bandha-vinirmuktāḥ** – freed from the bondage of birth;
- ◆ **padam** – state; **gacchanti** – attain; **anāmayam** – beyond pain/blissful.

Wise men endowed with equanimity, having abandoned the fruits of action, go to the abode beyond all sorrow and evil.